RISHIRAJ UPADHYAY

Senior Software Engineer II

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Software Engineer II with 13+ years of experience building websites and developer tools, mostly on the frontend, with hands-on REST API integration using Node.js and Express.js. Since 2022, I have owned Technical Requirements Documents (TRDs), architecture reviews and planning for customer-facing sites and developer docs on a headless CMS, and I built the frontend of ASK AI, an AI documentation assistant. I have also led and mentored a team of five engineers through code reviews and technical guidance. I led projects that grew traffic by ~30% and ~40%, built an event site that grew traffic by 90%, and raised performance scores from 45–60 to 80–90. I use Claude, Cursor, Codex, GitHub Copilot and ChatGPT to write code faster, and I always check the results with human review, testing and security checks, which cuts my coding time by ~60–70%.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Frontend: JavaScript, TypeScript, React.js, Next.js, Gatsby.js, HTML5, CSS3, Sass, Tailwind CSS, jQuery, Bootstrap, responsive design, web performance, Core Web Vitals, Lighthouse, accessibility (WCAG), SSR/SSG, cross-browser compatibility

Backend and Integrations: Node.js, Express.js, API-first architecture, API integration, frontend service integration

CMS: Contentstack headless CMS, Contentstack Delivery SDK, frontend integrations, content-driven web experiences, headless and composable architecture, Marketo forms, WordPress

Testing and Quality: Cypress, Jest, React Testing Library, unit testing, integration testing, TDD, debugging, refactoring, SEO

Delivery and DevOps: Git, CI/CD, production readiness, release management, deployment to Launch and Vercel

Technical Leadership: Technical Requirements Documents (TRDs), architecture reviews, complex solution design, code reviews, mentoring, stakeholder alignment, cross-functional communication

Ways of Working: Agile, Scrum, Jira

AI-Assisted Engineering: Claude, Cursor, Codex, GitHub Copilot, ChatGPT, agentic coding workflows, AI-assisted code review and test generation, prompt engineering, AI product integration (frontend and API), AI-native product interfaces, LLM-powered features (frontend and API integration), responsible AI use

WORK EXPERIENCE

Contentstack | Mumbai, Maharashtra

Senior Software Engineer II | Feb 2025 – Present

Stack: Contentstack headless CMS, JavaScript, TypeScript, React.js, Next.js, Gatsby.js, HTML5, CSS3, Sass, Tailwind CSS, API integration, Git, CI/CD

- Led frontend planning and delivery of Project Polaris, a performance, SEO and user-experience initiative for the Contentstack website, from development through testing, production readiness and release, driving ~30% site traffic growth and ~20% lower page load time.
- Profiled, debugged and refactored frontend bottlenecks using Lighthouse and Core Web Vitals, raising performance scores from the 45–60 range to 80–90 out of 100, improved responsive layouts and added a visitor-controlled dark and light theme switcher.
- Led frontend delivery of an interactive, animation-led Homepage Takeover that introduced platform capabilities as a guided journey, driving ~40% traffic growth and improving visitor-to-customer conversion by ~30%.
- Designed and built the frontend and API-integration layer for ASK AI, a chatbot-style documentation assistant that gives developers fast, relevant answers to questions asked in natural language, with suggested starter questions, follow-up support, and accessible, responsive presentation of AI-generated answers, now used by 80% of customers.
- Led and mentored a team of five engineers, reviewed code, and partnered with Product, Design, Marketing and Engineering on technical decisions, dependencies and releases.
- Embedded AI-assisted engineering into the team's workflow, using Claude and Cursor to plan designs, draft code, generate tests and review pull requests and TRDs, with mandatory human review and testing before merge, reducing coding time by ~60–70%.
- Used Claude, ChatGPT, Cursor, Codex and GitHub Copilot to analyze unfamiliar code, compare implementation options, speed up refactoring and Cypress and unit test writing, validating every change through code review and testing before release.

Senior Software Engineer I | Feb 2024 – Jan 2025

Stack: Contentstack headless CMS, JavaScript, TypeScript, React.js, Next.js, HTML5, CSS3, Tailwind CSS

- Built the Card, Assets, Entry and Content Type modules for Contentstack's Venus product and migrated existing components, moving the codebase to a React component-based architecture for a more consistent product experience.

- Built the six-page ContentCon event website for Contentstack's event in Austin and deployed it to the Contentstack Launch platform, resolving implementation and release issues for a dependable launch under event traffic, and the site contributed to 90% traffic growth.
- Created a global template for the Contentstack marketing website, so pages can be built to user requirements from reusable components.
- Mentored four engineers across two teams, reviewed code, and partnered with Product, Design, Marketing and Engineering on technical decisions and releases.
- Served as the sole TRD approver for the platform organization and led architecture reviews, setting technical direction beyond individual projects.

Software Engineer II | Feb 2022 – Jan 2024

Stack: JavaScript, TypeScript, React.js, Next.js, HTML5, CSS3, Contentstack Delivery SDK, Marketo

- Rebuilt the Contentstack corporate website and documentation site, including API and SDK documentation across 1,600+ pages, and supported product and API releases, improved the user experience, implemented Marketo forms to capture user data, reduced page load time by 45% and increased traffic by 35%.
- Presented design direction to stakeholders, secured approval, and turned it into implementation plans for the revamped sites.
- Owned solution planning and TRD management, chose the Contentstack Delivery SDK with React and JavaScript for the rebuilt sites, mentored five engineers, provided technical guidance and served as the sole code reviewer from design through release.
- Improved page speed, responsive layouts, accessibility and SEO across the documentation site, and refined how product and API information is presented so developers can find guidance faster.
- Added automated test coverage (Cypress, Jest) for the Contentstack main site and Docs site, and debugged and refactored frontend code to improve maintainability and support production releases.

Application Engineer | Sep 2015 – Jan 2022

Stack: JavaScript, Express.js, HTML5, jQuery, CSS3, Sass, TIBCO

- Supported TIBCO-based websites day to day, handling UI work and functionality, resolving issues and deploying updates to client servers.
- Fixed UI and functionality issues in Contentstack's Card, Assets and Entry modules.
- Developed responsive client demo websites tailored to requirements to showcase Contentstack CMS capabilities, with a focus on usability and performance.
- Revamped the Contentstack API documentation site end to end, rebuilding the full UI and functionality with Express.js and JavaScript and integrating the Contentstack JavaScript SDK, improving user experience and performance.

Datamatics Global Services Limited | Web Designer | Oct 2014 – Sep 2015

- Maintained the VFS Global website: investigated and fixed UI and functionality issues and verified affected pages for reliability.
- Improved page performance and built responsive interfaces with HTML5, CSS3, JavaScript, jQuery and Bootstrap, tested across browsers and screen sizes.

Kush Infosystem Private Limited | Web Developer | Jan 2013 – Oct 2014

- Built WordPress and custom websites from design handoff through development and deployment to client hosting, with performance and SEO in mind.
- Turned PSD designs into responsive pages with HTML5, CSS3, JavaScript, jQuery, Bootstrap and WordPress.

Thakur Polytechnic | Lecturer | Aug 2011 – Jan 2013

- Taught Microprocessors, Digital Techniques, HTML, Multimedia and Animation Techniques, and Management.
- Prepared lectures and practical exercises, guiding students through hands-on computer and web technology work.

EDUCATION

- **Bachelor of Engineering (B.E.) in Information Technology** | RTM Nagpur University | June 2008 – June 2011

CERTIFICATIONS

- Scrum Fundamentals Certified (SFC)

AWARDS AND RECOGNITION

- Contentstack Above and Beyond Award (twice) for animation-rich web experiences and CCON campaign websites
- Best Developer, Kush Infosystems, for technical contributions and development work
- Mentor, Smart India Hackathon 2018, jury member for technical paper presentations and project competitions, Thakur Polytechnic

NATIONALITY AND VISA

Nationality: Indian
Visa Sponsorship: Required

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Languages: English, Hindi, Marathi (all Full Professional Proficiency)